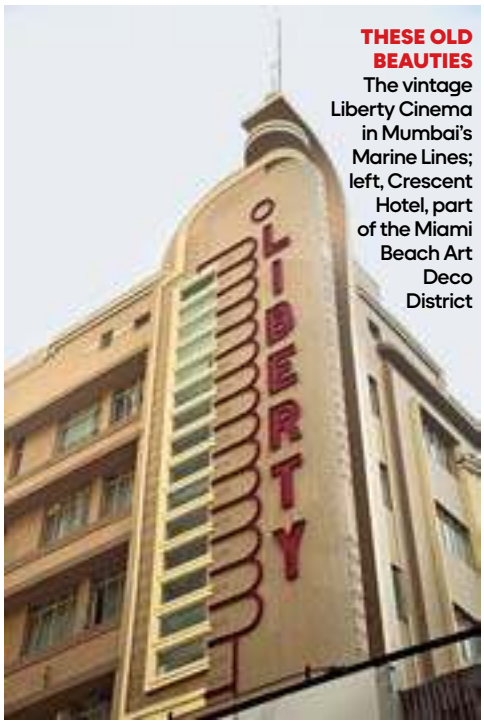
as well as differences that you can spot when viewing the Deco of both cities. "While Miami's Deco often leans into pastel palettes, nautical motifs and streamlined forms," she says, "Bombay Deco embraces tropical adaptations, ziggurats and Indian iconography.



THESE OLD BEAUTIES The vintage Liberty Cinema in Mumbai's Marine Lines; left, Crescent Hotel, part of the Miami Beach Art Deco District

There are striking similarities, too. For example, the Colony Hotel in Miami and Regal Cinema in Mumbai both embody a cinematic grandeur; Miami's Hoffman's Cafeteria and Mumbai's Eros Cinema share dramatic curves and stepped forms." Gayatri reminisces about growing up in Mumbai, walking past apartment buildings with elegant railings and sunburst patterns, and never realising they were Deco. "Now, strolling through South Beach, I see the same language in Miami's hotels and signage. It's like recognising a familiar accent in a foreign city," she smiles.

Art Deco Alive! comes alive in Mumbai between November 6 and 25, with the exhibition displayed at the Dr Bhau Daji Lad Museum, along with Art Deco artefacts like jewellery, furniture, silverware and memorabilia. Deco Talks & Walks will feature discussions and curated tours for heritage buffs, typography lovers, cinema buffs and children. A retail edit, as well as a screening of Mira Nair's *India Cabaret* (1985), will bring the Deco vibe to life.

Art Deco Alive! is also hoping to shine a spotlight on women who have been instrumental in keeping the movement going, but aren't often spoken about. "Barbara Baer Capitman, the visionary behind the preservation of Miami Beach's Art Deco District, and Perin Mistri, one of India's first women architects and a pioneer of Bombay Deco, are central to the exhibition," Salma explains. Their contributions are highlighted alongside iconic architects like Henry Hohauser in Miami and Master, Sathe & Bhuta in Mumbai. The exhibition places their work in dialogue, showing how preservation and innovation shaped two of the world's most extraordinary Deco landscapes."

When asked what they believe is the future of Deco and its relevance in modern urbanism, Smiti says, "The beauty of Deco is that it's always current. Its future lies in its ability to inspire contemporary design without being confined to nostalgia." For Salma, Deco is a lens into how cities adapt, modernise and express identity. "In Miami and Mumbai, Deco is woven into the urban fabric, and its resilience reminds us that thoughtful design can stand the test of time," she asserts. Gayatri agrees, "The challenge is to preserve this heritage while using its spirit to inspire inclusive and character-rich urban spaces. That is what makes Deco timeless—it keeps finding new ways to be relevant." ■

—Priya Pathiyan

WORLD'S A STAGE Prithvi Theatre trustees Kunal and Zahan Kapoor (second and third from right) at the opening night of the 2024 festival



Theatre veterans such as Paresh Rawal, Feroz Abbas Khan, Jyoti Dogra and Arundathi Nag will be in conversation with Pragya Tiwari for 'StageTalks'. This year, the festival is also introducing workshops, which Kapoor hopes to make a regular feature. "The aim is to encourage study and practice in the performing arts and have leading professionals share their insights and tools of the craft," he says. To start with, theatre enthusiasts will get an opportunity to learn from experts such as Abhishek Majumdar, Shernaz Patel and Naseeruddin Shah.

There will be live screenings of plays performed at the National Theatre in London, including *A Streetcar Named Desire*, *Inter Alia*, *Dr Strangelove* and *Present Laughter*. Prithvi Festival will also see several experimental works as well as a Bharatanatyam performance by Shreema Upadhyaya in *Leela: The Divine Play*. One of the highlights is a sitar performance by Ustad Shujaat Husain Khan. Let the show begin! ■

—Deepali Dhingra

Prithvi Festival will be held from Nov. 1-17 at Prithvi Theatre and Prithvi House, Juhu, Mumbai